

FREE GUIDE



The Complete Type 4 Wash Day Checklist

Every step, in order — so wash day finally feels simple.

by Schicgirl



Your Wash Day, In Order

Let's make wash day feel calm and clear. Once it becomes a simple sequence, the overwhelm fades — follow these seven steps in the order that suits your hair, print the sheet, and tick as you go.

THE 7 STEPS 1 Pre-wash → 2 Cleanse → 3 Deep condition → 4 Detangle → 5 Moisturise → 6 Style → 7 Protect

1 · PRE-WASH CHECKLIST

- ☐ Detangle gently on dry or oiled hair to reduce shedding
- ☐ Apply a pre-poo (oil or conditioner) to the lengths and ends
- ☐ Section hair into 4–6 twists to stay organised
- ☐ Optional: warm oil or a scalp massage to loosen buildup
- ☐ Set out all products and tools *before* you start

SCHICGIRL TIP

Pre-wash is where wash day is won. Detangling and pre-pooing on dry hair protects your length and makes every step that follows faster and gentler.

Cleanse & Deep Condition



2 · CLEANSING CHECKLIST

- ☐ Rinse with warm — not hot — water to open the cuticle
- ☐ Shampoo the scalp in sections; co-wash the lengths if dry
- ☐ Massage with fingertips, never nails
- ☐ Clarify every 2–4 weeks, or whenever there's noticeable buildup
- ☐ Rinse thoroughly — leave no residue behind

3 · DEEP CONDITIONING CHECKLIST

- ☐ Apply section by section on damp hair, roots to ends
- ☐ Concentrate the most product on your ends
- ☐ Cover with a cap; add gentle heat for low porosity (20–40 min)
- ☐ Use a moisture deep-conditioner most weeks; reach for a light protein treatment only if your hair feels weak, overly stretchy, or is breaking
- ☐ Rinse with cool water to seal the cuticle

Detangle & Moisturise



4 · DETANGLING CHECKLIST

- ☐ Detangle on slip — conditioner or water still in the hair
- ☐ Work in sections, from the **ends up** to the roots
- ☐ Fingers first, then a wide-tooth comb
- ☐ Take extra care at the nape and crown
- ☐ Re-twist each finished section to keep it tangle-free

5 · MOISTURISING CHECKLIST

- ☐ Start on damp hair with water or a water-based leave-in (L)
- ☐ Layer in the order your hair likes — many prefer **LCO** for low porosity and **LOC** for high, but test both and trust your results
- ☐ Smooth product down the shaft, then scrunch into the ends
- ☐ Seal the ends extra — they're the oldest and driest
- ☐ Keep layers light — don't overload

SCHICGIRL REMINDER

If you're ever unsure where to focus your care, choose your **ends**. They're the oldest, most fragile part of your hair — and they often decide how much length you keep.

Style & Protect



6 · STYLING CHECKLIST

- ☐ Style on damp — not soaking — hair for definition
- ☐ Choose a styler for your hold: gel, cream, or custard
- ☐ Smooth, then rake or shingle for clumped curls
- ☐ Air-dry or diffuse on low; don't touch while drying
- ☐ Let it set fully before fluffing or separating

7 · NIGHT PROTECTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Pineapple, or loosely band longer hair
- ☐ Satin bonnet or scarf — or a satin pillowcase
- ☐ Re-moisturise only dry spots with a light mist
- ☐ Avoid cotton — it drinks your moisture overnight
- ☐ Refresh in the morning with water + a little oil



Wash Day at a Glance

Print this page and keep it where you wash — your whole routine in seven moves.

- 1 **Pre-wash** — detangle, pre-poo, section
- 2 **Cleanse** — wash the scalp, rinse well
- 3 **Deep condition** — moisture (+ heat if low porosity)
- 4 **Detangle** — on slip, ends to roots
- 5 **Moisturise** — water first, then layer (LCO or LOC — test both)
- 6 **Style** — damp hair, define, dry undisturbed
- 7 **Protect** — satin overnight, refresh in the morning

THE 3 NON-NEGOTIABLES

- ✓ **Deep conditioning**
- ✓ **Moisturising on damp hair**
- ✓ **Satin protection at night**

Keep only these three consistent and your Type 4 hair will usually stay healthier, softer, and easier to manage.

YOUR NEXT STEP

You've got the basics now. The logical next step: *How to Build My Hair Routine*. A clear guide to follow step by step.

[Get the guide — \\$20 →](#)

“A calm wash day is a kept promise to your crown.”

SCHICGIRL WISDOM

CONTINUE YOUR HAIR JOURNEY

Is Your Scalp Holding You Back?

A perfect wash day starts at the root. If flakes, itching or buildup keep coming back, your scalp is asking for a different kind of care.

This guide gets to the root of dandruff in Type 4 hair — so a calm, healthy scalp becomes your new normal.

★ RECOMMENDED FOR YOU

1 • How to Build My Hair Routine

Build, step by step, the Type 4 routine that works for YOU — product order, wash day, the week, the night.

Get the guide — \$20 →

2 • Why Nothing Works

The 'diagnosis-first' system: finally understand *why* your products keep failing, then build the routine that actually works.

Get the guide — \$13 →

3 • Transitioning Hair

From relaxed to natural, gently and without breakage: manage two textures, a 90-day plan and trims.

Get the guide — \$7 →

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*You've already taken the most important step — choosing to understand your hair.
We'll be here for every step that follows.*

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